

Eat My Body and Drink My Blood II

Noah's Blood Commandment Prepared the Offense of John 6

Open to John 6. We will begin around verse 46.

From Noah, we learned that whether an animal was eaten for food or offered for sacrifice, the blood was not to be drunk. The blood was for atonement. If they drank or ate the blood, they were not covered. The same beasts whose dread had been upon man would turn on him.

Under the shadow, they had great authority. God told Noah the dread of man would be on every beast. As we learn more about sonship and the authority we have, we will be shocked at how much is available to us as God reveals it and we begin to walk in it.

Leviticus 17 says the blood had to be poured out and covered. The life was in the blood. If the life in that blood was not offered as sacrifice, then the animal did not become the sacrifice for them.

That is why Jesus' statement in John 6 was such a shock to Jewish hearers. Moses gave them bread from heaven, and Jesus said the bread He would give was His flesh. Then He said that unless they ate His flesh and drank His blood, they would have no life in them.

The Flesh Profits Nothing Because the Spirit Gives Life

Jesus explained Himself before the teaching ended:

"It is the spirit that quickeneth;
the flesh profiteth nothing;
the words that I speak unto you,
they are spirit,
and they are life."

The manna that came down from heaven under Moses could not change anything inwardly. It was under the shadow. The blood of goats and bulls could not purge the spirit from the consciousness of sin.

When Jesus says the flesh profits nothing, He is not saying His sacrifice is meaningless. He is saying natural flesh cannot give life. Life comes from the human spirit quickened by the life of God.

As He lives by the Father, the one who eats Him lives by Him. The life in His blood represents the resurrection life He gives into the human spirit.

No Man Had Seen the Father Until the Son Revealed Him

John 6:46 says:

"Not that any man hath seen the Father,
save he which is of God,
he hath seen the Father."

What do we do with all the preaching that Abraham, Moses, and Adam were in heaven seeing the Father before Christ? Jesus said no man had seen the Father at any time. Abraham is in heaven now, but before the Firstborn rose, the Old Testament saints waited in Abraham's bosom, a place of comfort where they waited for the promise.

Jesus is speaking as the only begotten Son, the One whose human spirit came into existence by the Father and into whom the mighty Logos poured Himself. He alone could say He had seen the Father.

The Son Stood on Earth While Remaining in the Bosom of the Father

In other places, Jesus says He is in the bosom of the Father, and that the Son of Man is in heaven. Even while standing on earth, in His new nature He stood in the intimate secret place of fellowship with the Father.

First John says:

"As he is,
so are we in this world."

The subject there is love. As He is in His glorified humanity, with that new nature and full capacity for agape, so are we in this world. I stand there too. I stand in the bosom of the Father by my new nature.

Perfect love casts out fear. What replaces fear is peace: an impenetrable place of stillness and quietness that cannot be breached. I know where that place is now. It is where my new nature put me, even while I am standing on this planet.

Each Limb of the Born-Again Trail Ministers Differently

Praying in tongues is the Holy Spirit ministering to my human spirit as Teacher. I love that ministry because He teaches my spirit so He can give power.

Speaking the Word in meditation is me pouring myself out in the authority and knowledge of God. My knowledge of Him increases in authority.

Fasting keeps the flesh under subjection and forces it below the operation of my human spirit. It executes the positional truth Jesus gave the flesh before I receive a glorified body: dead.

The angel limb teaches what my authority does in the incorporated structure of heaven, how faith and commands of faith are carried out in heavenly realms.

But the worship limb is different. Worship is my fellowship with the Father. Praying in tongues is the Holy Spirit ministering to me. Worship is me ministering to my Father.

Worship is the limb that will not cease. Tongues will cease. Prophecy will pass away when that which is perfect is come. But love never ceases. It crosses the barrier of death and continues.

Worship in Spirit and Truth Is Positional, Not a Breakthrough Feeling

When Jesus sat at Jacob's well and said the true worshipers would worship in spirit and in truth, most books I read described that as an experience. They said you may begin dry or in the flesh, then eventually break through and worship in the Spirit.

But Jesus was speaking positional truth. He was saying the Father had waited through the dispensations for a man to be born again, with a nature that could worship Him in spirit. The Old Testament saints could not give Him that worship.

The hour had now come because Jesus was there to make the new birth possible.

So do not stop worshipping because you feel dry or ugly. What makes you think that because you cannot feel Him receiving it, He is not receiving your worship? Heaven may be rejoicing that you feel terrible and still worship Him.

You are worshipping from the new nature.

The Bread of Life Ends Spiritual Death, Not Physical Death

John 6:47-51 says:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you,
He that believeth on me
hath everlasting life.
I am that bread of life.
Your fathers did eat manna in the wilderness,
and are dead.
This is the bread which cometh down from heaven,
that a man may eat thereof,
and not die."

When Jesus says the fathers ate manna and are dead, He is not merely speaking of physical death. Many who have eaten of Christ have physically died over the last two thousand years, but their spirits are alive with Him.

He is saying those fathers ate manna and remained spiritually dead. Manna could sustain the body, but it could not give resurrection life to the human spirit.

Jesus says:

"I am the living bread
which came down from heaven:
if any man eat of this bread,
he shall live for ever:
and the bread that I will give
is my flesh,
which I will give for the life of the world."

The Jews strove among themselves, asking how He could give them His flesh to eat. Jesus did not soften the statement. He added:

"Except ye eat the flesh of the Son of man,
and drink his blood,
ye have no life in you."

The Son Gives the Same Life the Father Gave Him

John 6:57 says:

"As the living Father hath sent me,
and I live by the Father:
so he that eateth me,
even he shall live by me."

The life Jesus lived by was the life the Father gave Him. John 5 explains it:

"As the Father hath life in himself;
so hath he given to the Son
to have life in himself."

The Son then gives that same life to us. The life in the Father was given to the Son, and the life in the Son is given to the one who eats of Him.

The Greater Work Is the Quickening of the Human Spirit

John 5:20 says:

"For the Father loveth the Son,
and sheweth him all things
that himself doeth:
and he will shew him greater works than these,
that ye may marvel."

The works just before this included the healing of the man at the pool who had been infirm thirty-eight years. The Father would show the Son a greater work than healings, miracles, and Old Testament resurrections.

That greater work was the quickening of the human spirit from death to life. Not even Adam had ever been raised from spiritual death. No human spirit had ever been quickened until Jesus.

That also helps us understand John 14:

"The works that I do shall he do also;
and greater than these shall he do;
because I go unto my Father."

"Works" after "greater" is supplied in italics. The greater thing is the new birth: the quickening of the human spirit made available because Jesus went to the Father.

The Father Judged All Men in the Son

John 5:21-22 says:

"For as the Father raiseth up the dead,
and quickeneth them;
even so the Son quickeneth whom he will.
For the Father judgeth no man,
but hath committed all judgment unto the Son."

The Father judges no man because every man was judged in the Son. When Jesus died, all died. When you accept Him, you accept His life. God is not judging you for your own sins, because He judged Jesus for them. Therefore, everyone who comes to the Son can be accepted.

"He that heareth my word,
and believeth on him that sent me,
hath everlasting life,
and shall not come into condemnation;
but is passed from death unto life."

That is spiritual death to spiritual life.

The Dead in Abraham's Bosom Heard the Son's Voice

John 5:25 says:

"The hour is coming, and now is,
when the dead shall hear the voice
of the Son of God:
and they that hear shall live."

This is not primarily a graveside verse about physical resurrection. Jesus is speaking of the millennial hour of His generation. The spiritually dead who had waited in accounted righteousness, those in Abraham's bosom who had believed the promise, would hear His voice and live.

Not everyone who died before the cross heard and lived. Those who adhered to the salvation promise of their dispensation heard. Those who did not were not given a second chance after burning in torment.

Abraham believed God could quicken the dead and call things that be not as though they were. God counted that to him for righteousness. When Jesus came, He fulfilled the promise and quickened those who had waited in faith.

The Words of Jesus Are Spirit and Life

John 6:63 says:

"It is the spirit that quickeneth;
the flesh profiteth nothing:
the words that I speak unto you,
they are spirit,
and they are life."

The flesh cannot produce this life. The manna did not produce it. The animal blood did not produce it. It is the spirit that receives life.

When you give yourself to His words, you give yourself to Him. When you keep His commandments, He and the Father come and make their abode with you. You are in Him, He is in you, and the Father is in both through that new nature.

The Holy Spirit's ministry is another part of the teaching, but this is the new nature and the bosom of the Father. As Jesus lived by the Father, and by every word proceeding from the mouth of God, the one who eats Him lives by Him.

I am a new creation. I now live and take my instructions from every word that proceeds from the mouth of my Father.